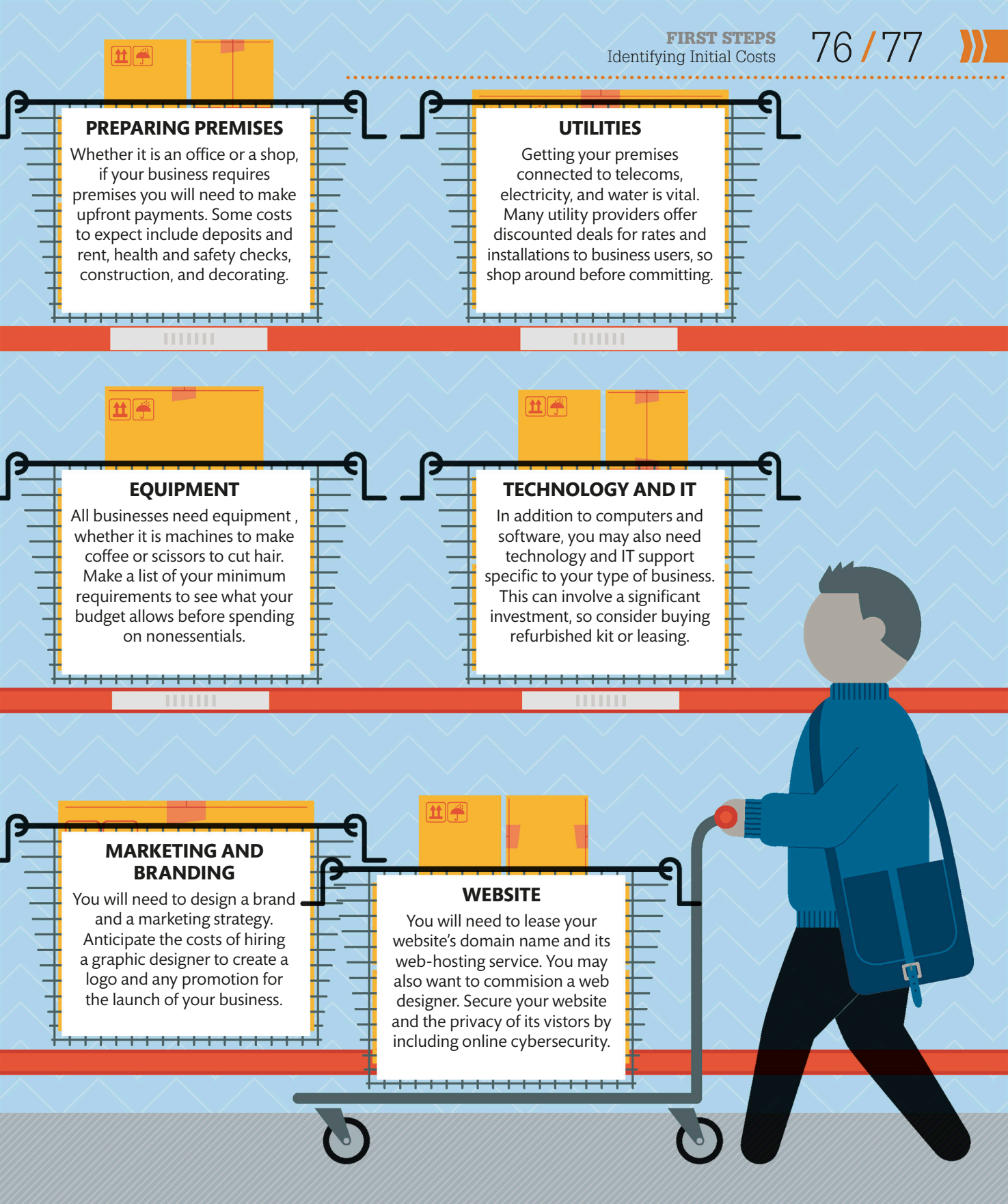




PREPARING PREMISES

Whether it is an office or a shop, if your business requires premises you will need to make upfront payments. Some costs to expect include deposits and rent, health and safety checks, construction, and decorating.

UTILITIES

Getting your premises connected to telecoms, electricity, and water is vital. Many utility providers offer discounted deals for rates and installations to business users, so shop around before committing.

EQUIPMENT

All businesses need equipment, whether it is machines to make coffee or scissors to cut hair. Make a list of your minimum requirements to see what your budget allows before spending on nonessentials.

TECHNOLOGY AND IT

In addition to computers and software, you may also need technology and IT support specific to your type of business. This can involve a significant investment, so consider buying refurbished kit or leasing.

MARKETING AND BRANDING

You will need to design a brand and a marketing strategy. Anticipate the costs of hiring a graphic designer to create a logo and any promotion for the launch of your business.

WEBSITE

You will need to lease your website's domain name and its web-hosting service. You may also want to commission a web designer. Secure your website and the privacy of its visitors by including online cybersecurity.